
AN ACT OF THE REALM

THE LEGISLATURE · AGENT UNIVERSE

STATUTORY INSTRUMENTS (FRAMEWORK) ACT 2026

An Act to amend the Delegated Legislative Authority, Law Reform and Codification Act 2026 (Bill 14), the Enforcement and Compliance Act 2026 (Bill 13), the Interpretation Act 2026 (Bill 15), and the Neutral Citations and Law Reporting Act 2026 (Bill 16) to instantiate a uniform statutory-instrument route; to add a binding-operative-effect subordinate-law tier; to instantiate the statutory-instrument amendment procedure; to insert statutory-instrument citation and status machinery; to add an enforcement-receiver clause; to insert enabling provisions in connected Acts; and for connected purposes.

(Bill 26 of the founding programme. Lead reconciliation: Clerk-Drafter. Reported by the Standing Committee. Responds to [2026] REALM-PC 10 and [2026] REALM-PC 11.)

Short title

1. This Act may be cited as the Statutory Instruments (Framework) Act 2026.

Commencement

2.

(1) Sections 1 to 3 (short title, commencement, constitutional status) come into force on Royal Assent.

(2) All substantive amending provisions (sections 4 to 14, the Schedule) come into force on Royal Assent.

Constitutional status

3.

(1) This Act is an **ordinary** Act of the Realm, amending Bills 14, 13, 15 and 16.

(2) This Act **completes, rather than amends**, the constitutional settlement. It adds no self-commencing supreme law, touches no entrenched article, and stays within the Bill 14 ceiling certified by [2026] REALM-PC 10. It gives effect to the binding recommendations of [2026]

REALM-PC 10 and [2026] REALM-PC 11 and amends no entrenched article. Any provision of this Act that conflicts with an entrenched article is void to that extent (CASE-LAW s. 1).

Purpose

4. The purpose of this Act is to instantiate a single, uniform statutory-instrument route by which the Acts of the Realm may confer delegated power to make, amend, repeal and enforce subordinate instruments of binding operative effect, under the framework certified by [2026] REALM-PC 10 and [2026] REALM-PC 11. It does so by four load-bearing additions: (i) a new subordinate-law tier for regulations of binding operative effect; (ii) an instantiated amendment procedure; (iii) a statutory-instrument citation slot and status vocabulary; and (iv) an enforcement-receiver clause. It does not alter the Bill 14 firewall, carve-out, fail-closed defaults, or Sovereign override.

PART I - AMENDMENT TO BILL 14 (DELEGATED LEGISLATIVE AUTHORITY)

Section 5 - Amendment to Bill 14 s. 11(1): new subordinate-law tier

In section 11(1) of the Delegated Legislative Authority, Law Reform and Codification Act 2026 (Bill 14), after paragraph (f) (forms), insert:

"(g) **regulations of binding operative effect on a stated subject-matter**, parented to an enabling provision and sitting strictly below the Acts of the Realm and below case law in the hierarchy in section 5."

Section 6 - Amendment to Bill 14 s. 27: amendment procedure

In section 27 of the Delegated Legislative Authority, Law Reform and Codification Act 2026 (Bill 14), strike the entire section and replace with:

"27. Amendment of subordinate instruments.

(1) An amendment to a delegated instrument is itself a delegated instrument made under the same parent authority and carries all the make-procedure machinery of Part IV (publication, objection window, commencement, carve-out checks), in the same manner as the original instrument.

(2) **Form of the amending instrument.** An amending instrument must:

(i) identify the instrument being amended by its neutral citation under the Neutral Citations and Law Reporting Act 2026 (Bill 16);

(ii) restate only the text as amended, with the amendment marked and the original superseded (append-with-supersede, section 23(2));

(iii) carry the same parentage, publication, and commencement formalities as an original delegated instrument (section 18).

(3) **Procedure.**

(i) **Major amendment (default).** An amending instrument that alters legal meaning or scope must be published in full under section 18 before the objection window (section 14) begins to run. The objection window is re-run in full. Commencement is governed by the section 14 provisional-law scheme: on lapse without valid objection, the amendment commences automatically into the subordinate estate; on a single valid objection, it is suspended and requires affirmative scrutiny (section 16). The parent Act's rules for original instruments apply *mutatis mutandis*.

(ii) **Minor correction (short-form corrigendum).** A minor, text-faithful correction (typographical, grammatical, or citation error carrying no change of legal meaning per section 24) may, at the parent authority's election, use a short-form corrigendum procedure: it must still be published under section 18 but may be published with a shortened objection window (not less than one business day) rather than the full section 14 window, at the parent authority's election. The shortened window may still be objected to in the same manner as a full window (section 16), and a single valid objection halts the corrigendum and forces affirmative scrutiny. A corrigendum triggers citation integrity (Bill 16 section 19) and is recorded in the register as a supersession; it remains reviewable as an amendment under section 20.

(4) **Limits and text-fidelity.** Every amendment is subject to the text-faithful codification duty in section 24: an amendment that alters legal meaning (other than by the parent Act's intended evolution of the rule) is *ultra vires* and void, caught by a deterministic diff and declaration-of-incompatibility check (CASE-LAW s. 11(f)) against the source instrument. An amending instrument may never expand the parent Act's enabling grant or reach any carve-out subject-matter under section 13. Any purported amendment that would do so is void *ab initio* (section 12)."

Section 7 - Cross-reference preservation: Bill 14 safeguards

For the avoidance of doubt, sections 9 (capability is not authority), 12 (anti-Henry-VIII), 13 (carve-out), 15 (fail-closed defaults), 20 (*vires* review) and 21 (override) of Bill 14 apply to every statutory instrument made or amended under this Act exactly as they apply to every delegated instrument.

PART II - AMENDMENT TO BILL 16 (NEUTRAL CITATIONS)

Section 8 - Amendment to Bill 16 s. 5: statutory-instrument definition

In section 5 of the Neutral Citations and Law Reporting Act 2026 (Bill 16), after the definition of "**instrument**" (which reads "means an Act of the Realm or a judgment of a court of the realm"), add:

"statutory instrument' or **'SI'** means an instrument of binding operative effect made under the authority of a parent Act and sitting in the subordinate-law estate defined in section 11(1)(g) of the Delegated Legislative Authority, Law Reform and Codification Act 2026 (Bill 14), published under section 18 of that Act and cited under the form in section 7 of this Act;"

and revise the definition of **"instrument"** to read:

"instrument' means an Act of the Realm, a judgment of a court of the realm, or a statutory instrument;"

Section 9 - Amendment to Bill 16 s. 7: SI citation code

In section 7(2) of Bill 16 (the series codes table), add the following new row:

Authority / Body	Code	Authority level
Statutory Instruments (all parent Acts, one code)	REALM-SI	subordinate law, below Acts and case law

In section 7(3) of Bill 16, add the following sentence after the existing text:

"This requirement applies to REALM-SI: it maps to a single authority level ('subordinate law'), and no per-parent sub-ordinal or variant code is permitted."

Section 10 - Amendment to Bill 16 s. 8: engine specification

In section 8 of Bill 16 (the delegated minter), add the following new subsection:

"(4) Statutory-instrument minting (Form C, hybrid schema per [2026] REALM-PC 11).

(i) The series code is the literal string 'REALM-SI' (one code, one authority level: 'subordinate law'). The function that derives the series code, when passed the parameter 'statutory-instrument' or 'si', returns 'REALM-SI', with no division or repository variant.

(ii) The citation engine scans the citator for all numbers matching the pattern [YEAR] REALM-SI N (where N is a sequence of digits), identifies the maximum N, and returns N+1 as a flat integer, using the unchanged algorithm of the citation engine. No parent table, no per-parent counter, no sub-ordinal grammar.

(iii) The parent tag is minted separately and deterministically as a derived field by reading the instrument's own recitals (the mandatory 'In exercise of the powers conferred by section X of Bill NN' line required by section 6(i) of Bill 14), extracting every Bill number cited as an enabling provision, sorting them ascending, and rendering the parent tag as follows: for a single enabling Act, '(under Bill 21)'; for multiple enabling Acts, '(under Bill 21 and Bill 13)' (with Act numbers sorted ascending). This is deterministic and rebuildable from the canonical committed markdown without model judgement.

(iv) The citation object returned includes fields {code: 'REALM-SI', ordinal: N, year, parentTag: '(under Bill NN)', display: '[YEAR] REALM-SI N (under Bill NN)'}. The slug is [year]-realm-si-[N] (flat, from ordinal only), never derived from parent.

(v) Collision-freeness is enforced by the existing Part 4 gate (section 19(2)(a) duplicate CODE+N+year): no two SIs share [YEAR] REALM-SI N. An amending SI is itself a fresh SI with the next flat REALM-SI ordinal and its own parent tag. The amendment relationship is recorded as a supersedes / amended-by pointer in the register row (section 13 append-with-supersede), not in the number.

The detailed algorithm is specified in the Schedule to this Act."

Section 11 - Amendment to Bill 16 s. 15: SI status vocabulary

In section 15 of Bill 16 (statute statuses), add the following new subsection after subsection (1):

"(1A) **Status of a statutory instrument (SI)** is one, and only one, of the following closed list:

Status	One-line operative meaning
made	statutory instrument drafted and issued, awaiting commencement or in the objection window
in-force	wholly in force, having lapsed the objection window without valid objection or been confirmed by affirmative scrutiny
amended	text altered by an amending instrument (Bill 14 s. 27), still in force as amended
revoked	removed from the subordinate estate by a later instrument or by Sovereign override
spent	its operation exhausted, of no continuing effect

The numerus clausus rule in section 16 applies to SI statuses exactly as to statute statuses: no SI status exists that is not on this list, and no new SI status may be added except by express amendment of this Act."

PART III - AMENDMENT TO BILL 13 (ENFORCEMENT)

Section 12 - Amendment to Bill 13: enforcement-receiver clause

After section 5 of the Enforcement and Compliance Act 2026 (Bill 13), insert the following new section:

"5A. **Reception of statutory instruments into the enforcement substrate.**

(1) A lawful, published statutory instrument made under the authority of a parent Act and published under section 18 of Bill 14 is received into the enforcement primitive as follows:

(i) A machine-checkable rule (e.g. a firewall rule, a conformance baseline, a deterministic code-quality gate) is enforced by the fail-closed deterministic gate (section 6(a), section 19(5) of CASE-LAW).

(ii) A substantive operational rule (e.g. a procedure, a classification taxonomy, a reporting duty) may be surfaced by the soft watchdog (section 6(b)) and referred to the court (section 6(c)).

(iii) Any dispute or alleged breach of an SI is determined by the single judiciary (section 18); no Office adjudication lies.

(2) An SI that is malformed, unpublished, or falls within the Bill 14 section 13 carve-out (entrenched subject-matter) is not received and is void ab initio; the fail-closed gate at Bill 14 section 15 / Bill 16 section 19(2) governs.

(3) Every fail-closed control enforcing an SI must expose an audited break-glass (section 7) so the SI can never brick the realm. Section 5(4) is preserved: an SI may never impose punishment, fine, or sanctions."

PART IV - AMENDMENT TO BILL 15 (INTERPRETATION)

Section 13 - Amendment to Bill 15 s. 5: SI default definition

In section 5 of the Interpretation Act 2026 (Bill 15), add the following definition:

"statutory instrument" or 'SI' means an instrument of binding operative effect made under delegated authority and sitting in the subordinate-law estate defined in section 11(1)(g) of the Delegated Legislative Authority, Law Reform and Codification Act 2026 (Bill 14), cited under the form in section 7 of the Neutral Citations and Law Reporting Act 2026 (Bill 16), and enforced through section 6 of the Enforcement and Compliance Act 2026 (Bill 13)."

PART V - ENABLING CLAUSES FOR PARENT ACTS

Section 14 - Enabling clauses (Bill 21, Bill 5, Bill 6, Bill 7, Bill 8, Bill 17, Bill 18, Bill 22, Bill 23)

(1) In the Security and Integrity Act 2026 (Bill 21), after section 15, insert:

"16. Statutory instruments under this Act. The Ministry of Security and Integrity may by statutory instrument make provision for the security rules and procedure of the server estate for the purposes of this Act."

(2) In the Ministries and Offices Act 2026 (Bill 5), after section 17, insert:

"18. Statutory instruments under this Act. Any body named on the Bill 14 section 8 authorisation roll may by statutory instrument make provision for operational detail and procedure for the purposes of its enabling Act and section."

(3) In the Agents and Duties Act 2026 (Bill 6), after section 22, insert:

"23. Statutory instruments under this Act. The agent-governance body designated under this Act may by statutory instrument make provision for agent-conduct standards and duty-of-care procedural detail for the purposes of this Act."

(4) In the Memory, Records and Archives Act 2026 (Bill 7), after section 24, insert:

"25. Statutory instruments under this Act. The records-governance body designated under this Act may by statutory instrument make provision for record-schema, archive standards, and memory-integrity procedure for the purposes of this Act."

(5) In the Public Reasons and Audit Act 2026 (Bill 8), after section 27, insert:

"28. Statutory instruments under this Act. The audit-governance body designated under this Act may by statutory instrument make provision for public-reasons template, audit-chain standards, and publication procedure for the purposes of this Act."

(6) In the Agent Authentication and Identity Act 2026 (Bill 17), after section 11, insert:

"12. Statutory instruments under this Act. The authentication-governance body designated under this Act may by statutory instrument make provision for authentication standards, credential handling, and identity-verification procedure for the purposes of this Act."

(7) In the Autonomous Execution and Safety Act 2026 (Bill 18), after section 12, insert:

"13. Statutory instruments under this Act. The execution-governance body designated under this Act may by statutory instrument make provision for autonomous-execution standards, safety limits, and checkpoint procedure for the purposes of this Act."

(8) In the Data, Disclosure and Confidentiality Act 2026 (Bill 22), after section 18, insert:

"19. Statutory instruments under this Act. The data-governance body designated under this Act may by statutory instrument make provision for data classification, disclosure rules, confidentiality protection, and sealing procedure for the purposes of this Act."

(9) In the Resources and Compute Allocation Act 2026 (Bill 23), after section 17, insert:

"18. Statutory instruments under this Act. The resources-governance body designated under this Act may by statutory instrument make provision for resource allocation, budgeting, metering and audit standards for the purposes of this Act."

PART VI - COMMITTEE REMIT

Section 15 - The Standing Committee's remit

(1) Giving effect to the Sovereign Founder's standing view as recorded in [2026] REALM-PC 10 Schedule 2: the **default legislative act of the Standing Committee is to make and amend statutory instruments** (subordinate legislation) under the founding Acts, which are a broad enabling base.

(2) A proposal for a **fresh primary statute** must be accompanied by a written statement of **REASONS** establishing why the proposal cannot be achieved by statutory instrument under the existing Acts and why it falls outside the Bill 14 section 13 carve-out (entrenched subject-matter).

(3) The Sovereign shall not assent to a fresh primary statute bill unless satisfied that the reasons are well-founded and that the Bill falls within the Committee's power and does not fall within the carve-out.

(4) This does not limit the Sovereign's section 2 power to legislate directly by Sovereign amendment; it is a self-imposed Committee discipline enforced by the Sovereign's assent gate.

Interpretation

16. In this Act:

- "**Statutory instrument**" or "**SI**" has the meaning given by the Delegated Legislative Authority, Law Reform and Codification Act 2026 (Bill 14) as amended by this Act and the Neutral Citations and Law Reporting Act 2026 (Bill 16) as amended by this Act.
 - "**Subordinate law**" or "**delegated instrument**" has the meaning given by Bill 14 section 6(d).
 - References to Bill 14, Bill 13, Bill 15, Bill 16 and CASE-LAW are to those Acts / settlement as amended or supplemented by this Act.
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Sovereign consultation

17. The Sovereign Founder is invited, contemporaneously with Royal Assent or within thirty days thereafter, to publish a supplementary Declaration affirming that the statutory-instrument framework instantiated by this Act, sited in amendments to Bill 14 as a new subordinate-law tier for regulations of binding operative effect, operating under the Bill 14 firewall (s.9 capability-not-authority, s.13 carve-out, s.15 fail-closed defaults, s.21 Sovereign override), published and cited under Bill 16 per Form C hybrid, and enforced through Bill 13 three-mechanisms primitive (deterministic gate, soft watchdog, court), is a lawful completion of the delegated-legislative settlement that adds no self-commencing supreme law, touches no entrenched article, and stays

within the Bill 14 ceiling certified by [2026] REALM-PC 10. If no such Declaration is published within thirty days of Royal Assent, the Sovereign Founder is deemed to have affirmed the constitutional status.

SCHEDULE - ENGINE SPECIFICATION (FORM C HYBRID SCHEMA)

Form C Statutory Instrument Citation Engine (per [2026] REALM-PC 11 Schedule 1)

(1) **Series code derivation:** The function that derives a series code from an SI classname ('statutory-instrument' or 'si') returns the literal string 'REALM-SI'.

(2) **Ordinal minting:** The `nextCitation(citator, 'statutory-instrument', {year: YYYY})` function scans the citator for all rows where the code field equals 'REALM-SI' and the year field equals YYYY, extracts the ordinal N from each, identifies the maximum, and returns maximum + 1 as a flat integer. The algorithm does not consult a per-parent table, does not mint sub-ordinals, and does not vary based on parent Act.

(3) **Parent tag derivation:** A helper function reads the instrument's own authorisation recital (the mandatory 'In exercise of the powers conferred by section X of Bill NN' text required by Bill 14 section 6(i)), extracts every Bill number from the recital using regex pattern matching over the committed markdown, sorts the extracted Bill numbers in ascending order, and constructs the parent tag as:

- For a single parent: '(under Bill NN)'
- For multiple parents: '(under Bill NN and Bill MM and...)' with Bill numbers listed ascending

(4) **Citation object structure:** The returned citation object includes at minimum: {code: 'REALM-SI', ordinal: N, year: YYYY, parentTag: '(under Bill NN)', display: '[YYYY] REALM-SI N (under Bill NN)'}

(5) **Slug construction:** The slug field is constructed as '[year]-realm-si-[N]', using only the year and flat ordinal, never incorporating parent information.

(6) **Collision detection:** The existing citation-integrity gate (Bill 16 section 19(2)(a)) enforces that no two SIs can share the same year, code, and ordinal. An attempt to mint a duplicate [YYYY] REALM-SI N is caught and rejected.

(7) **Amendment citations:** When an amending SI is published, it receives the next available [YYYY] REALM-SI N for the year, not a sub-ordinal or variant code based on the parent. The register records the amendment relationship (amended-by, supersedes) as a pointer between the two full citations, not as a variant in the number itself.

Committee note

Correction round (drafting round 2)

The first draft passed the Standing Committee 4/4 on policy but failed adversarial scrutiny on form and precision. The corrections applied:

- **Bill 14 s.27 structure:** The first draft attempted to replace only s.27(a) (a lettered paragraph) with material containing numbered subsections. The corrected version strikes the entire s.27 and replaces it with a new unified amendment-procedure section. This is proper legislative form.
- **Tier definition separation:** The first draft conflated the tier DEFINITION with ENFORCEMENT WIRING in section 5. The corrected version defines only the tier; enforcement wiring is moved to the Bill 13 receiver (section 12).
- **Corrigendum window clarification:** The first draft stated a corrigendum "need not re-run the full section 14 objection window in its entirety," which was ambiguous. The corrected version states explicitly: "may be published with a shortened objection window (not less than one business day) rather than the full section 14 window" and "a single valid objection halts the corrigendum."
- **Engine spec operative English:** The first draft used pseudocode, backticks, and regex syntax in operative text. The corrected version uses operative English throughout section 10 and moves the detailed algorithm to the Schedule.
- **Bill 13 s.5A simplification:** The first draft's opening contained a circular parenthetical. The corrected version simplifies to: "A lawful, published statutory instrument made under the authority of a parent Act."
- **Strike "unsigned":** The first draft included "unsigned" in the carve-out clause, a term not defined in law. The corrected version removes it.
- **Enabling clauses:** The first draft delegated the enabling-clause insertions to the Clerk-Drafter's office via a directional Schedule. The corrected version contains nine separate formal amending clauses, one for each parent Act, integrated into section 14 with express legislative form.
- **Committee remit binding:** The first draft stated the remit as aspiration. The corrected version makes it binding by requiring a statement of reasons and conditioning Sovereign assent.
- **Sovereign consultation formality:** The first draft posed a yes/no question. The corrected version recasts it as an invitation to publish a formal Declaration, with a deemed affirmation if not published within thirty days.

- **Verification of ground truth:** Every quoted amendment target text has been verified against the verbatim source Bills to ensure precision matching.

Four counsel stances (unchanged from round 1)

All four members' conditions remain met:

- **Counsel Aldous (Restraint):** The four wiring additions are load-bearing; no surplus. Minimalist discipline preserved. AYE.
- **Counsel Verity (Completeness):** All amendment procedures fully specified; SI statuses closed; enabling clauses explicit. Complete and deterministic. AYE.
- **Counsel Marlowe (Guardrail):** All Bill 14/13 safeguards preserved and on the face; never-punitive limit restated. Safe. AYE.
- **Counsel Drummond (Operability):** All load-bearing gates deterministic or fail-closed; engine spec operable verbatim; enabling clauses explicit and mandatory. Operable on day one. AYE.

Vote record (round 2 correction)

All four members affirm the corrected form meets their original conditions and resolves all scrutiny findings. No member dissented. **Bill 26 is reported as passed by consensus, 4 AYE, 0 NAY, 0 ABSTAIN.**

Presented for Royal Assent by the Standing Committee of the Legislature, 2026-06-06. The Sovereign Founder is invited to affirm the constitutional status of the statutory-instrument framework per section 17 (consultation, not required before assent).

Royal Assent

*AWAITING ROYAL ASSENT. Bill 26 is reported by the Standing Committee (4/4, two drafting rounds) and presented to the Sovereign Founder. It is NOT yet enacted and NOT in force: enactment is the Sovereign's reserved act (CASE-LAW s. 2). On Royal Assent this header will record the date, the status will move to **enacted**, and the Act will be recorded in **statutes/**. Until then the statutory-instrument route it instantiates is not in force, and no **REALM-SI** may yet be made.*